

ScriptScreen — Installation Guide

ScriptScreen is distributed as a single archive. After unpacking it and running the install script for your platform, the application is ready to use. The installer also sets up the third-party components it needs (Node.js/npm, whisper.cpp speech models, and ffmpeg).

Everything is installed **under your user account** — administrator/root rights are only requested if Node.js or ffmpeg have to be installed system-wide.

What gets installed, and where

Component	Location	Notes
Application (Flutter + Electron)	Linux: <code>~/.local/share/scriptscreen</code> macOS: <code>~/Library/Application Support/ScriptScreen</code> Windows: <code>%LOCALAPPDATA%\ScriptScreen</code>	Includes a local copy of Electron pulled by <code>npm install</code> .
Speech recognition (whisper.cpp + models)	<code>~/whisper.cpp</code> (Windows: <code>%USERPROFILE%\whisper.cpp</code>)	The app reads this fixed path. Large; kept on uninstall unless you purge.
ffmpeg (audio conversion)	<code>~/whisper.cpp/bin</code>	Bundled; used only when importing non-WAV audio.
Launcher / menu entry	Linux: <code>~/.local/bin/scriptscreen</code> + menu entry macOS: <code>~/Applications/ScriptScreen.command</code> Windows: Start Menu shortcut	—

Windows note: the installer writes **no registry keys** for ScriptScreen. App discovery is a Start Menu shortcut file only. (Installing Node.js via winget, if it is missing, is a separate third-party step that may touch the registry.)

Requirements

- A working internet connection for the first install (to download Electron, the speech models, and — if missing — Node.js). The archive does not include speech models — the installer downloads the ones you select.
- ~1.5 GB free disk space plus the size of the speech models you install (`small` ≈ 0.5 GB, `large-v3` ≈ 3 GB).
- Node.js 18 or newer. The installer will install it for you if it is missing (Linux: system package manager; macOS: Homebrew; Windows: winget).

- **SDL2** is required for *live* transcription. On Linux/macOS the installer installs it for you (Linux: package manager, `sudo`; macOS: Homebrew). On Windows **SDL2.dll** is bundled inside the archive — nothing to install.

GPU builds — check your machine first

Some archives are built with GPU acceleration (CUDA for NVIDIA cards, or Vulkan) — you can recognize them by `-gpu-cuda` / `-gpu-vulkan` in the archive name. Before installing such an archive, run the check script from the unpacked archive — it tells you whether this machine can use it:

```
# Linux
./check-gpu.sh
```

```
# Windows
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\check-gpu.ps1
```

It checks for an NVIDIA driver (CUDA), a Vulkan runtime, and tries to start the archive's own whisper binary, then prints a verdict per build type. It is read-only — nothing is installed or changed. If it says the archive's binaries do not start on your machine, use the CPU build instead: it works everywhere, just slower on long recordings. (On macOS, GPU acceleration via Metal is automatic — there is nothing to check.)

Installer options

The install script accepts a couple of optional flags:

- `--models "<a> <b>"` — speech models to make sure are present; any that are missing are downloaded from Hugging Face (default: `small`). Names match the ScriptScreen UI, e.g. `small`, `medium`, `large-v3`, `turbo`.
- `--log <file>` (Windows: `-Log <file>`) — write the install log to a custom file. By default the installer **always** writes everything it prints to `install.log` inside the app directory (see the table above) — attach that file when reporting a problem.
- `--no-log` (Windows: `-NoLog`) — do not write a log file.

```
# Linux example: install and pre-download two models
./install.sh --models "small large-v3"
```

```
# Windows example
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\install.ps1 -Models "small"
```

Linux

1. Unpack the archive:

```
tar -xzf scriptscreen-<version>-linux.tar.gz
cd scriptscreen-<version>-linux
```

2. Run the installer:

```
./install.sh
```

If Node.js/npm is missing it will be installed with your package manager ([apt](#), [dnf](#), [pacman](#) or [zypper](#)), which requires your [sudo](#) password.

3. Launch ScriptScreen from your application menu, or run [scriptscreen](#) in a terminal. (If the command is not found, add `~/.local/bin` to your [PATH](#) — the installer prints the exact line to add.)

macOS

1. Unpack the archive (double-click the [.tar.gz](#) in Finder, or use Terminal):

```
tar -xzf scriptscreen-<version>-macos.tar.gz
cd scriptscreen-<version>-macos
```

2. Run the installer by double-clicking [install.command](#) in Finder, or:

```
./install.command
```

If Node.js is missing, Homebrew is used (and installed first if necessary). The installer clears the Gatekeeper "quarantine" flag on the bundled binaries so they can run.

3. Launch ScriptScreen by double-clicking [ScriptScreen.command](#) in *Home ► Applications* (Finder ► Go ► Home).

If macOS still blocks a component, right-click it ► **Open**, then confirm once. This is only needed the first time.

Windows

1. Unpack the archive: right-click [scriptscreen-<version>-windows.zip](#) ► **Extract All...**, then open the extracted folder.
2. Run the installer — right-click [install.ps1](#) ► **Run with PowerShell**, or from a PowerShell window in that folder:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\install.ps1
```

If Node.js is missing it is installed via **winget**. After a fresh Node.js install you may need to open a new terminal and re-run the script so **node** is on the **PATH**.

3. Launch ScriptScreen from the **Start Menu** (search "ScriptScreen"), or run **scriptscreen.cmd** from **%LOCALAPPDATA%\ScriptScreen**.

Uninstalling

Run the uninstall script from the same unpacked archive folder. By default this removes the application, launcher and menu entry but **keeps** the large speech models in **~/whisper.cpp**. Add the purge flag to remove those too.

Linux

```
./uninstall.sh          # keep ~/whisper.cpp
./uninstall.sh --purge  # also remove ~/whisper.cpp
```

macOS

```
./uninstall.command     # keep ~/whisper.cpp
./uninstall.command --purge # also remove ~/whisper.cpp
```

Windows

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\uninstall.ps1          # keep
whisper.cpp
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\uninstall.ps1 -Purge    # also
remove it
```

Because nothing is written to the Windows registry and everything lives under your user profile, uninstalling is simply the removal of these files. Node.js, Homebrew and any system ffmpeg are left in place — remove them separately if you no longer need them.

Troubleshooting

- **"node/npm not found" after install on Windows** — open a *new* PowerShell window (so the updated **PATH** is loaded) and re-run **install.ps1**.
- **App starts but transcription fails** — check that **~/whisper.cpp/build/bin** contains **whisper-cli/whisper-stream** and that **~/whisper.cpp/models** contains the **ggml-*.bin** model you selected in the app.

- **Importing MP3/M4A fails, WAV works** — ffmpeg is missing. Confirm `~/whisper.cpp/bin/ffmpeg` exists, or install ffmpeg system-wide.
- **npm install failed** — re-run the installer; it is safe to run again. Most failures here are a dropped network connection while downloading Electron.
- **Electron download fails repeatedly (ECONNRESET in the npm log)** — the Electron binary is downloaded from GitHub releases, which some networks block or reset. The installer automatically retries via a mirror; to use a different mirror, set `ELECTRON_MIRROR` before re-running the installer, e.g. `ELECTRON_MIRROR=https://npmmirror.com/mirrors/electron/` (PowerShell: `$env:ELECTRON_MIRROR = 'https://npmmirror.com/mirrors/electron/'`).